

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Vanessa and Sally share bizarre stories.



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you heard any strange news stories recently?
- What is the craziest news story you have ever heard?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences and strange events.
- I can discuss experiences I have and haven't had.
- I can write about past events.





Let's Explore!

The final game of the season is tomorrow and **I can't wait**.*

* "I can't wait" means you are very eager to do something.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** V. You are hilarious. Marco. I haven't heard that name in a while.
- Vanessa:** Hmm. Oh by the way, did you hear the news about the bank robbery yesterday?
- Sally:** No, What happened?
- Vanessa:** You won't believe it, a man walked into a bank downtown and gave the teller a note. According to the news, the note said, "I have a bomb, fill the bag with cash."
- Sally:** Wow. That is nuts. Was anybody hurt in the robbery?
- Vanessa:** Nobody knew about it. The teller filled the bag with money. I guess he stole something like ten thousand dollars cash and ran out the door.
- Sally:** So he got away?
- Vanessa:** No, five minutes later the man came back to the bank, put the bag on the counter, apologized to the teller and then waited for the police.
- Sally:** The remorseful bankrobber.
- Vanessa:** Have you ever heard a story that crazy before?
- Sally:** Well, there was the freeway sign accident story. Have you heard that one?
- Vanessa:** Oh right! Yeah. I did. I have heard a lot of strange stories, but that was the strangest.
- Sally:** Is it me, or have there been a lot of bizarre stories in the news lately?
- Vanessa:** There has been a few.
- Sally:** Maybe I should blog about all the ridiculous stories I have heard recently.
- Vanessa:** Why not? That topic sounds as good as any. I know a lot of strange and unusual stories I can tell you.
- Sally:** Oooo. I can't wait.



Let's Practice!

Here are some new words to talk about strange events.

Instructions: Look for the words in the word search.

1. nuts
2. ridiculous
3. hilarious
4. get away
5. remorseful
6. crazy story
7. bizarre

R	Y	A	Y	F	G	V	B	S	X	V	Q
V	S	R	S	K	R	O	M	C	Z	X	B
C	T	G	D	L	J	J	K	R	Z	Z	C
Z	U	J	F	P	D	U	B	A	R	R	G
E	N	K	G	Y	C	C	V	Z	R	E	V
W	X	G	E	T	A	W	A	Y	G	M	M
A	Z	H	D	S	J	A	W	S	H	O	F
D	X	C	C	V	M	E	R	T	J	R	A
M	R	I	D	I	C	U	L	O	U	S	O
J	J	W	O	B	I	Z	A	R	R	E	S
U	H	Q	U	P	F	G	H	Y	K	F	Y
P	A	S	G	L	S	K	A	Y	I	U	T
N	Z	X	F	M	Q	Z	C	S	I	L	G



Let's Practice!

Sally tells Vanessa about the different events she has heard of recently.

Instructions: Read the sentences below and circle the incorrect word.

1. I have never steal before, but my brother did when he was a little kid.
2. She haven't recognized the criminal yet.
3. I haven't hear that name in a while.
4. Has there be a lot of bizarre stories in the news lately?
5. That robber have been the most remorseful criminal the police have ever heard of.





Extension Activity

Talk about past experiences and past events!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write about strange events or coincidences that happened in your life in the past year.
- Expand and add any past events that happened in your country or in the world.
- Write a short paragraph 8 to 10 sentences long.
- Share your paragraph with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about coincidences and strange events.

☐ ☐

I discuss experiences I have and haven't had.

☐ ☐

I write about past events.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **hilarious** (adjective): extremely funny
e.g. You are hilarious.
- **teller** (noun): one who works in a bank to receive or pay out money over the counter
e.g. You won't believe it, a man walked into a bank downtown and gave the teller a note.
- **nuts** (adjective): weird, crazy
e.g. Wow. That is nuts.
- **to get away** (verb): to escape; flee
e.g. So he got away?
- **remorseful** (adjective): full of, or characterized by, deep and painful regret
e.g. The remorseful bankrobber.
- **can't wait** (expression): used when you are excited about something to happen
e.g. **Vanessa:** Why not? That topic sounds as good as any. I know a lot of strange and unusual stories I can tell you.
Sally: Oooo. I can't wait.



Learning Points

Simple Past

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

Usually, when you use the Simple Past tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

*Yesterday, a robber **stole** something like ten thousand dollars in cash.*

Here is another example:

*Ten minutes later, the robber **came** back to the bank.*

Remember that there are both regular and irregular verbs. Look at the chart for examples of the Simple Past tense verbs.

Regular Verbs:

Present	Past
discover	discovered
recognize	recognized

Irregular Verbs:

Present	Past
think	thought
know	knew

Examples:

- *What happened?*
- *Yesterday, he stole something like ten thousand dollars in cash and ran out the door.*
- *The teller filled the bag with money.*





Learning Points

Present Perfect

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

I have learned English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

He has bought a painting. = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

To emphasize the result of the action, use the simple form.

- *Have you heard the latest news?*
- *I haven't heard that story.*

Examples:

- *Have you ever heard a story that crazy before?*
- *Have you heard that one?*
- *I have heard a lot of strange stories, but that was the strangest.*
- *Has there been a lot of bizarre stories in the news lately?*
- *There has been a few.*

